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1. The most important concept I learned from this unit of the course was that there is a difference between the types of audiences. The types of audiences include experts, technicians, executives, and nonspecialists. I never thought to break them down like this before, but it is so helpful. I have already begun to apply this to my career when communicating with different people around the enterprise. I used to do a version of this, but not to this extent or to this level of binning. Before, I would just try to assess the individual's level of knowledge based on their position instead of thinking about what they *need* to know in their position.

2. The concept most new to me was the differentiation between intended audiences and potential audiences. When I write professionally, I only ever consider the targeted audience who I am directly addressing. Sure, I realize that others may see what I wrote. But I never considered altering my message to give just a token of context to those who may not be as technically inclined on the subject.

3. Learning about audience analysis helped me focus on what my audience needs to know vice what they are capable of understanding. As I mentioned earlier, I have always tried to tailor my message based on my perception of the recipient's level of knowledge, background, or expertise in a subject. I see how this can cause frustration from a higher-level executive when I send him a detailed technical report instead of a succinct summary with operational impacts of the technical anomaly. Sure, he can understand what I am saying. Sure, he probably cares. He does not, however, need to know all the extra fluff that the engineers need to know.

4. The biggest difference I saw between emails and memos was the formality that automatically is associated with a memo. In my line of work, emails can serve as formal communication full of taskings and directives based on executive level intent. But they can also be informal, friendly, and quick check ins. Frankly, you never actually know what you will get when you receive an email. A memo is always formal and must be taken (almost) as gospel in the workplace. As such, they are always written in the most professional and succinct tone possible.

5. The writing skill that improved the most was my executive summary writing skills. I have mentioned it a couple of times now, but learning to boil down my updates to senior leaders is already showing to be a valuable capability in my current role at work. It also helps to understand the bigger picture of why this problem matters, to be fair. But knowing that you can leave out details that, to you, are key to understanding the root of the problem is acceptable when communicating up is essential.

6. I would say I did not learn anything new about ethics in writing, per se. I have mandatory ethics training every year as well as a master's in organizational communication, so my ethics background is solid. Ethics is extremely important to technical and professional writers because it ties back to your credibility. Your credibility means everything in the workplace. Losing

credibility will cause you to potentially lose your job and the references that would have been. There are also health and safety implications with ethics, but these are obvious and can go without much explanation.

7. I feel like I have beaten this horse in several answers before this one. These skills are already helping me with communicating up my chain of command and tailoring my message.

8. Honestly, I cannot say right now. I am inclined to say no, but I probably would have said there was nothing new for me to learn at the start of this course. I would have been wrong. Although, most of the content is a refresher for me. I work for an organization that is responsible for billions of dollars in space systems. I write technical reports and summaries daily. I will continue to remind myself of the course concepts as I write at work and try to get better each day.